



An automated license plate reader in Frisco, Texas. (Spectrum News)

NEWS

DPS provides guidance on ALPR usage to law enforcement agencies

BY JOSEPHFER WILLIAMS | KANSAS CITY
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After Gov. Mike Kehoe signed [Executive Order 26-18](#), the Department of Public Safety (DPS) published guidance for Missouri law enforcement agencies on the best practices related to the use of automated license plate readers (ALPR).

Executive Order 26-18, signed on Sep. 18, was an order that looked to protect the safety and security of Missourians and target technology like ALPR and Flock Cameras.

county sheriffs' offices, as well as the work of national law enforcement associations," Department of Public Safety Director Mark James said. "What stood out from my individual discussions with Missouri chiefs, sheriffs and the Missouri State Highway Patrol was that many agencies have proactively instituted very significant guardrails to protect privacy, the overwhelming desire to protect constitutional rights, and support for strong penalties for any violation of constitutional rights."

James added he's heard countless cases in which ALPRs were crucial in making arrests and crimes being solved – ranging from child abductions to highly organized national retail theft operations to homicides.

"Automatic license plate readers have proven to be an incredibly effective crime-fighting tool at a time when many law enforcement agencies are experiencing very significant officer shortages," Gov. Kehoe said. "However, comprehensive legislation must be enacted to guarantee ALPRs are only used for legitimate law enforcement purposes, privacy is protected, and there are very serious consequences for those that break the rules regarding any ALPR restrictions that are adopted."

DPS guidance is designed to ensure strict safeguards on the use of ALPR technology, including Flock Safety cameras, and recommendations for best practices related to ensuring:

- a legitimate law enforcement purpose for any ALPR data search;
- individual accountability for anyone with access to ALPR data;
- independent verification of ALPR alerts before enforcement;
- limited (30 days in most cases) retention of ALPR data;
- routine auditing (at least monthly) and targeted reviews of ALPR use; and

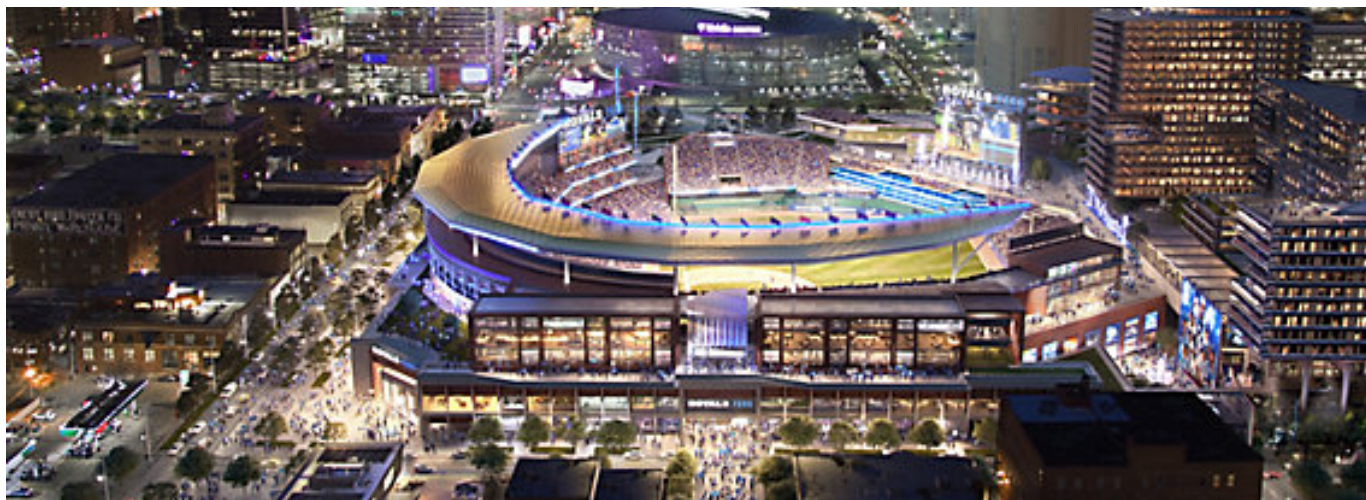


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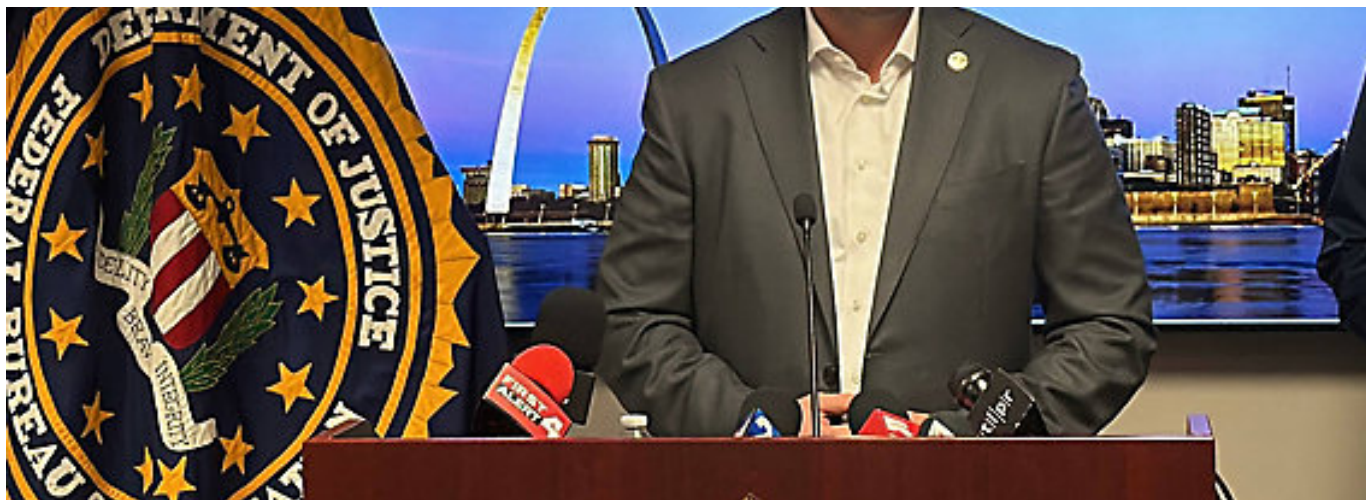
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